



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Age is Only a Number



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know someone who looks and acts younger than their age?
- What do they do? How do they behave?
- Do you want to be like them when you are elderly?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about jobs, work, and staying healthy.
- I can write a short diary entry.
- I can write about what I want or would like to do.

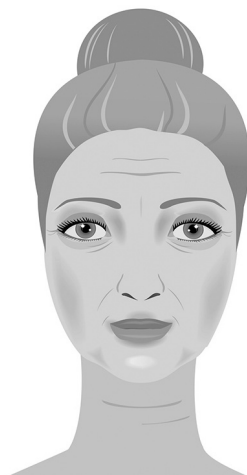




Let's Explore!

Listen to Vanessa read her diary entry about an **unexpected*** chat.

* unplanned



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

January 5th
Age Is Only A Number

Dear Diary:

I met someone today at work who has changed the way I feel about getting older. If I look and act anything like her when I'm in my eighties, I will be truly blessed. I want to take a leaf out of her book!

This elderly lady came into the restaurant and we soon started up a conversation. She was well-dressed. Actually she was wearing a very fashionable outfit. I complimented her on her appearance. She looked very familiar. I learned that she used to be a news anchor for Channel 7. We quickly became engrossed in a conversation about healthy living and aging. She stressed the need for a balanced diet, regular exercise and an active social life. Also, she mentioned that she was heavily into meditation and yoga. Above all, she recommended a positive attitude to life and not to sweat the small stuff. Dwelling on things only makes you anxious and frustrated, she said. She still volunteered at a local animal shelter twice a week. She refused to use modern gadgets or technology. She preferred to live a simple life and often advised others against being dependent on social network sites.

After this meeting, I would really like to start making some changes in my life, especially about getting too worried about silly things and taking better care of myself. I want to be less reliant on technology, too. Plus, she said stress gives you wrinkles! If you want to learn about living a great life, she is the perfect example.





Let's Practice!

It's hard to maintain a work life balance.

Instructions: Select a word from the box to correctly complete the sentences. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

at work	meditation	volunteering	work	blessed	engrossed
engross	volunteered	simple	gadgets	balancing	balanced

1. I met someone today _____ who has changed the way I feel about getting older.
2. We quickly became _____ in a conversation about healthy living and aging.
3. She stressed the need for a _____ diet, regular exercise and an active social life.
4. Also, she mentioned that she was heavily into _____ and yoga.
5. If I look and act anything like her when I'm in my eighties, I am truly _____.
6. I was surprised to hear that she still _____ at a local animal shelter twice a week.
7. She refused to use modern _____ or technology.
8. She preferred to live a _____ life.



Let's Practice!

Vanessa learned some valuable life lessons from her customer.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Put each word in the correct order.

1. I / am / look / older, / I / to / like / want / her. / When

2. would / eighties. / active / like / to / Vanessa / healthy / and / into / her / stay

3. I / like / some / changes / to / start / really / in / my / life. / would / making

4. I / to / take / a / book. / out / of / her / want / leaf

5. want / be / technology. / I / reliant / on / to / less

6. If / to / learn / example. / perfect / about / living / a / life, / want / she / is / the / you great



Extension Activity

Who do you admire?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose a friend or family member you admire.
- Write a 80 - 100 word diary entry about their work and lifestyle.
- Use the zero conditional in a sentence.
- Use the words *I want to* and *I would like to* in the diary entry.
- Read the diary entry aloud to the friend or family member.
- How do they respond? Are they happy? Surprised?

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write a diary entry about a friend or family member.

☐ ☐

I include phrases like *I want to* and *I would like to* in a diary entry.

☐ ☐

I read my diary entry aloud to a partner or family member.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to dwell** (verb): to think or talk about something for a long time
e.g. When you dwell on things you can't control, it only makes you anxious and frustrated.
- **to bless** (verb): to provide a person or a place with something good or desirable
e.g. If I look and act anything like her when I'm in my eighties, I will be truly blessed.
- **to take a leaf out of someone's book** (expression): to learn from another person's actions
e.g. I want to take a leaf out of her book.
- **to compliment** (verb): to say nice things about someone or something
e.g. I complimented her on her appearance.
- **to usher** (verb): to lead (someone) to a place
e.g. She smiled and ushered me to sit with her as she finished off her Greek salad and iced tea.
- **to engross** (verb): to hold the complete interest or attention of (someone)
e.g. We quickly became engrossed in a conversation about healthy living and aging.
- **wrinkle** (noun): a small line or fold that appears on your skin as you grow older
e.g. Plus, she said stress gives you wrinkles!
- **let alone** (conjunction): to say nothing of
e.g. I hope to still recognize my own family let alone help in the community.
- **animal shelter** (noun): a place that looks after unwanted animals
e.g. She still volunteered at a local animal shelter twice a week.





Learning Points

Writing a Diary

There are no set rules for writing a diary entry; however, a diary entry should have some specific features.

Features of a Diary Entry

- Diary entries are written in the first person.
For example: *Last Friday, I went to the most amazing movie with my friend.*
- You can include a title to your diary entry.
- You start your diary entry with the words, *Dear Diary,*
- A diary starts with a date at the top of the page.
- Diaries are usually written in the Past tense.
- The opening sentences should express your state of mind.

Examples:

- *I met someone today at work who has changed the way I feel about getting older.*
- *We quickly became engrossed in a conversation about healthy living and aging.*





Learning Points

Joining clauses with *if, when*

You use the zero conditional to talk about general truths and certainties and to give instructions.

There are two parts to the sentence.

One part is the **condition**. The other part is the **result**.

Form: **If** or **When** + subject + the Present Simple Tense

You can flip the two parts of the sentence so that the result comes first.

Subject + the Present Simple tense/Imperative + *if* or *when* + subject + the Present Simple

Condition		Result	
<i>If I eat healthy food,</i>		<i>I have a lot of energy.</i>	
Result	Condition		
<i>Call me</i>	<i>if you want to go to yoga tonight.</i>		

Notice that you only need a comma (,) if you say the condition first.

Examples:

- *When I am that age, I hope to be as active as she is.*
- *When I am older, I want to look like her.*

